

Email Not Working? Try These 5 Things First

Work down the list in order and check each box. Most email problems end before you reach the bottom — and you didn't break anything.



1. Is your internet working?

Open your web browser and try loading any website. If nothing loads, it's a Wi-Fi problem, not an email problem. Turn Wi-Fi off and back on, or move closer to your router.



2. Have you been signed out?

Apps log you out sometimes, especially after updates. If it asks you to sign in, enter your password. Forgot it? Every email service has a “Forgot Password” button — use it. No shame in it.



3. Does the email app need an update?

Open the App Store (iPhone) or Play Store (Android), search for your email app, and if you see an Update button — tap it. Outdated apps stop working all the time.



4. Is your phone's storage full?

Go to Settings and check your storage. If it's full, delete old photos or apps you never use. Old text messages are a sneaky space hog too.



5. The most reliable fix: delete the app and reinstall it.

You will NOT lose your email — it lives on the mail server, not in the app. Delete the app, download it fresh from your app store, and sign back in. Nine times out of ten, problem solved.

The Old Guy's insider tip

Some providers (Comcast is a big one) block outside email apps unless you allow them. If a fresh install still won't connect: sign into your email on the provider's **website**, go to Settings, then Security, and check the box that allows **third-party email apps**. That one checkbox solves more email mysteries than almost anything else.

Still expecting an email that never came? Peek in your Spam or Junk folder before you worry — good mail lands there by mistake more often than you'd think.

Want more help like this, every week, in plain English?

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